Milan Gatarić

BACKEND SOFTWARE ENGINEER | JAVA / SPRING BOOT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience building and supporting enterprise Java applications in pension, financial, and insurance domains. Strong hands-on background in Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs, relational databases, SQL and stored procedure optimization, Kafka-based event-driven systems, and production troubleshooting, with working knowledge of AWS cloud environments. Experienced with high-throughput, data-intensive systems where stability, scalability, latency, and reliable data processing are critical. Served as Deputy Team Lead for two years while remaining hands-on, coordinating delivery, resolving technical blockers, working directly with international clients, and contributing to technical design decisions across monolith, modular monolith, and microservices architectures.

TECHNOLOGIES AND SKILLS

Backend	Java 8, 11, 21; Spring Framework; Spring Boot; Spring Batch; Async Processing
APIs, messaging and integration	REST; Kafka; gRPC; SOAP; OpenAPI; SwaggerHub; Redis
Cloud	AWS (Working Knowledge)
Data and SQL	PostgreSQL; Microsoft SQL Server; MySQL; Hibernate; JPA; Stored Procedures; Query Optimization
Architecture	Microservices; Modular Monolith; Monolith; Event-Driven Architecture
Production and monitoring	Grafana; Production Troubleshooting; Performance Analysis; Critical Issue Resolution
Delivery and tools	Git; Maven; CI/CD; Jenkins; Bamboo; Jira; IntelliJ IDEA
AI-assisted development	Claude Code; AI-Assisted Implementation and Code Support
Key strengths	High-Throughput and Data-Intensive Systems; SQL and Backend Performance Optimization; Distributed Systems; Event-Driven Architecture; Technical Ownership; Team Coordination; Client-Facing Technical Communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer / Deputy Team Lead | Naovis

Jul 2021 - Jul 2026
Novi Sad, Serbia

- Worked on high-throughput, data-intensive production systems handling large volumes of traffic and data, with a focus on stability, scalability, reliability, and backend performance.
- Built and modernized backend services using Java and Spring Boot across monolith, modular monolith, and microservices architectures, migrating legacy components while protecting business-critical pension workflows.
- Developed and optimized Microsoft SQL Server stored procedures and backend data-access flows to improve live data retrieval, query performance, and production latency.
- Participated in the design and development of a Kafka-based event-driven architecture for a document generation microservice, publishing events after documents were successfully generated and stored to notify downstream services. Additionally, used Kafka together with the Outbox Pattern to optimize a scheduled job and improve reliable event processing.
- Designed and maintained service integrations using REST, gRPC, SOAP, OpenAPI, and SwaggerHub, supporting reliable communication between internal and external systems.
- Investigated and resolved production issues, coordinated deployments and testing, and handled high-priority technical blockers affecting clients and internal teams.
- Acted as Deputy Team Lead for two years, coordinating delivery during the Team Lead's absence, supporting developers, promoting engineering best practices, and contributing to technical decisions.
- Worked directly with international clients to gather requirements, challenge and refine technical specifications, shape system designs, review progress, and address feedback and concerns.
- Developed and modernized NEO, a salary and retirement savings platform supporting the occupational pension business of one of Switzerland's largest private pension funds, while optimizing critical backend workflows to improve system stability and reduce latency.

Technologies: Java 8/11/21, Spring Framework, Spring Boot, REST, Kafka, AWS, Microsoft SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Hibernate, JPA, Stored Procedures, Query Optimization, Spring Batch, Async Processing, gRPC, SOAP, OpenAPI, SwaggerHub, Microservices, Modular Monolith, Monolith, Event-Driven Architecture, Git, Maven, CI/CD, Bamboo, Grafana, Apache Struts, JSP, Claude Code, AI-Assisted Development

Software Developer | DDOR Osiguranje

Jul 2019 - Jul 2021
Novi Sad, Serbia

- Built and maintained Java applications supporting multiple insurance business lines as a core member of the software development team.
- Designed and maintained Jenkins CI/CD pipelines and coordinated deployments across test and production environments.
- Delivered business features, performed release testing, resolved production defects, and supported stable releases and incident recovery.
- Managed and tuned complex relational databases and SQL workloads to improve performance, reliability, and data integrity.

Technologies: Java 8, Apache Struts, SOAP, Hibernate, JPA, Stored Procedures, Query Optimization, MySQL, Ant, JSP, Jenkins, Eclipse

Software Developer Intern | Novalite

Jan 2019 - Feb 2019
Novi Sad, Serbia

- Built a full-stack internal web application for managing projects, employees, and technology stacks
- Developed RESTful services with ASP.NET Core 2, reusable Angular 5 components, and an optimized Microsoft SQL Server data model.

Technologies: ASP.NET Core 2, Angular 5.0, MSSQL

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technologies
Faculty of Sciences, Department of Mathematics and Informatics - Novi Sad, Serbia
Computer Technician
Secondary Technical School - Kula, Serbia

LANGUAGES

Serbian: Native | English: Upper-Intermediate (B2)

SELECTED PROJECT | BACKEND & FRONTEND DEVELOPMENT

NoPressure Wear | E-commerce Web Application

Personal project | Java / Spring Boot backend and React storefront & administration

Designed and developed an e-commerce application covering the customer shopping journey and store operations, from product discovery and checkout to inventory, order management, content administration, and business reporting.

Architecture & backend engineering

- Chose a modular monolith architecture to organize business capabilities within a single deployable backend, with the goal of simplifying future extraction into microservices as the application grows. Separated responsibilities across controllers, services, repositories, DTOs, and persistence entities.
- Built REST APIs with Spring Boot, Spring Data JPA/Hibernate, PostgreSQL, and Flyway migrations; implemented request validation, centralized exception handling, pagination, sorting, native SQL filtering, and soft deletion to preserve order history.
- Implemented product and category management with nested categories, dynamic attributes, image/video galleries, SKU-based color variant linking, size and color filtering, and stock tracking per variant.
- Implemented registration, login, email verification, password reset, JWT authentication, OAuth2 social login, and role-based authorization for ADMIN, EMPLOYEE, and CUSTOMER. Separated stateless API security from OAuth2 login and enforced service-level access rules.
- Developed carts, guest and registered checkout, address management, coupon validation, delivery fees, order lifecycle tracking, and purchase-time price snapshots. Integrated Stripe PaymentIntents, saved payment methods, webhook signature verification, and payment status updates alongside cash on delivery.
- Built transactional HTML emails, order status notifications, scheduled email retries, abandoned-cart reminders, and low-stock notifications. Added customer reviews, favorites, store locations, and configurable legal content.
- Implemented administrative dashboards and revenue, order, product, and customer reports, including PDF and Excel exports; added configurable store settings, promotions, banners, popups, and catalog filters.

Frontend & user experience

- Built a responsive React storefront and admin panel with Vite and Tailwind CSS: product search and filtering, product galleries and variants, favorites, cart, Stripe checkout, order tracking, profile and address management, and reusable administration components.
- Integrated REST APIs through Axios with JWT handling; used React Router, TanStack Query, React Hook Form, reusable hooks and context, toast notifications, loading states, and English/Serbian localization with i18next.

Quality, integrations & delivery

- Wrote JUnit 5, Mockito, MockMvc, and integration tests for business logic, controllers, authorization, token invalidation, variant stock, filtering, and reporting. Configured GitHub Actions CI with PostgreSQL and Maven verification.
- Containerized the backend, PostgreSQL, and nginx-served frontend with Docker Compose. Integrated Cloudinary/local media storage, background removal, Sentry monitoring, Spring Boot Actuator, and Caffeine caching.

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, JWT, OAuth2, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, PostgreSQL, Flyway, Maven, Lombok, WebClient, Stripe, JavaMail, React, JavaScript, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Axios, React Router, TanStack Query, React Hook Form, i18next, Docker, nginx, GitHub Actions, JUnit 5, Mockito, MockMvc, Cloudinary, Sentry, Caffeine, Apache POI, OpenPDF.